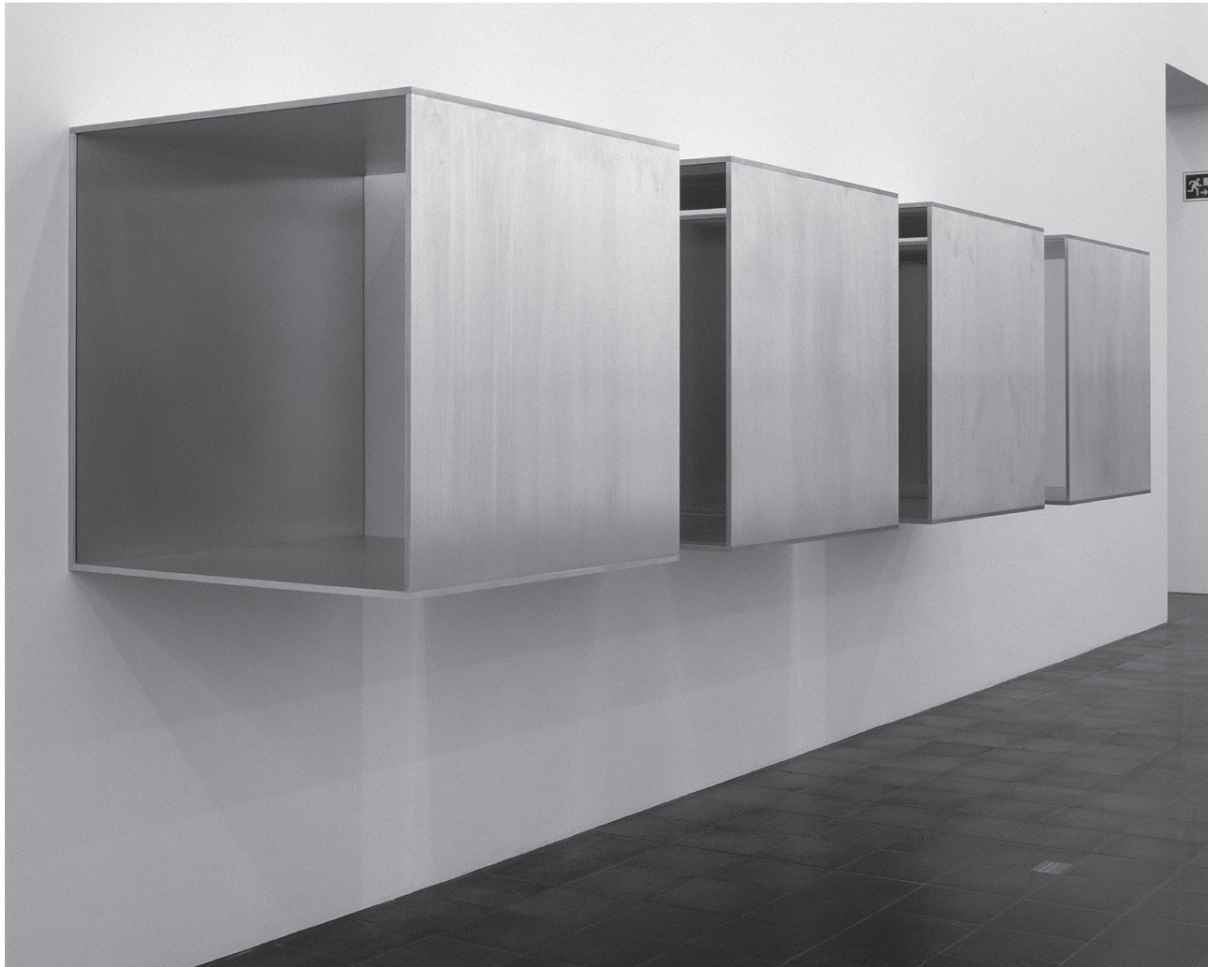


Minimalism

In 1965, British philosopher Richard Wollheim (1923–2003) wrote an essay called 'Minimal Art', referring to Colour Field painting and Dada. The term was not new – it had already been used in 1929 by the Ukrainian Futurist David Burliuk (1882–1967), but it gained momentum in the 1960s, specifically describing a style of art characterized by detached restraint, plain geometric compositions and structures, and industrially processed materials, such as house bricks or fluorescent lights.

Frank Stella (b.1936) became particularly influential after exhibiting his series of Black Paintings, consisting of black stripes with no hidden meanings in 1959. Donald Judd (1928–94) rejected the name 'Minimalist', but explained the concept as having a compositional 'wholeness'. Other Minimalists included Robert Morris (b.1931), Yves Klein (1928–62), Robert Rauschenberg, Ad Reinhardt and Carl Andre (b.1935). Minimalists never worked or exhibited as a group, but common features included large scale, simplicity and modular or serial compositions.



Judd, *Untitled*, 1984